

RUGUMAHO

A Simple Guide to Growing Your Blog & Podcast Audience

Prepared for Ariane Rugumaho

1. Writing for Your Readers (Simple Blog SEO)

SEO doesn't have to be technical. At its heart, Google wants to show people high-quality, relevant writing. Here is how to write your posts to naturally attract readers:

- **Make Headlines Descriptive:** Avoid generic titles like *'My Sunday'* or *'Workout Tips'*. Instead, write what people actually search or feel: *'Cultivating Mindful Habits for a Silent Morning'* or *'A Weekend Finding Stillness in Musanze's Valleys'*.
- **Use Clear Subsections:** Break your article up into sections using simple headers. Google reads these headers to understand the structure of your writing.
- **Interlink Your Work:** In every new article you write, include links back to 2 or 3 of your older articles (for example: *'...as I wrote in my post about slow travel...'*). This keeps readers browsing your website longer.
- **Quality Over Quantity:** One beautifully written, deeply personal, and helpful journal entry once a week is far better than publishing short, rushed updates daily.

2. Building Your Substack & WhatsApp Circles

These are your 'high-trust' channels. They let you reach your readers directly without relying on social media algorithms.

- **The Substack Newsletter:** Treat your newsletter as a personal letter. Write a warm, brief greeting and summarize the themes of your latest blog post. Always include a clean, bold link: *'Read the full journal entry on Rugumaho.com'*.
- **WhatsApp Channels:** Set up a public WhatsApp Channel (which keeps phone numbers private). When you publish a post, share a 2-sentence hook + the link. People open WhatsApp immediately, leading to instant traffic.

3. The Podcast & YouTube Strategy

YouTube is the second largest search engine in the world. Using it to host your podcast is the single most powerful way to build deep connection and find new search traffic.

The Visual Podcast Setup

Set up a cozy, quiet corner with warm lighting. Keep the background clean and simple. You do not need expensive studio setups—just a clean smartphone camera and a good microphone (like a lapel or USB condenser mic) for premium, crisp audio.

Creating Search-Friendly Video Titles

Avoid titling your videos as *'Rugumaho Podcast Episode 1'*. Nobody searches for that. Title your episodes based on the core question or search phrase your viewers care about:

Good Example: 'How to Actually Stay Consistent with Fitness as a Busy Mom | Podcast'

Good Example: 'Finding Stillness: My Simple Guide to Mindful Slow Mornings | Podcast'

The Repurposing Flywheel

Maximize your effort by splitting one single piece of content into multiple social touchpoints:

Step 1: The Long Video	Upload the full 15–30 minute video podcast episode on YouTube.
Step 2: The Shorts	Cut the episode into 3 vertical clips (under 60s) showing key quotes with auto-captions. Upload to YouTube Shorts and Instagram Reels.
Step 3: The Write-Up	Publish the key takeaways as a written journal entry on your blog, embedding the YouTube player.

4. Launching the Podcast: A Step-by-Step Idea

- **Episode 1 Concept:** Start with a welcoming, honest topic. For example, *'Why I Decided to Slow Down'*. Share your personal transition from a busy, rushed life to intentional living, motherhood, and launching this blog.
- **Podcast Hosting:** Use a free distributor like **Spotify for Podcasters**. It automatically publishes your audio episode to Spotify, Apple Podcasts, and Amazon Music in one click.